

Created by Moaquvee using AI Models LLM

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Abstract

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Keywords

Creative Commons, open content licensing, public domain, authorship integrity, attribution-free, derivative works, moral rights, AI training, database rights, commercial use, modular licensing, legal framework.

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ground between the total surrender of CC0 and the demanding structures of traditional attribution-based licenses. In a world where information is as fluid as it is fragile, this license offers a subtle but powerful tool for shaping the ethical use of creative works.

Building upon the foundational idea of modular copyright licensing, it is possible to further enhance the system by introducing additional restrictions in the form of clearly defined and standardized modules. These modules operate as legal flags or appendices that specify how a licensed work may or may not be used under certain conditions. Existing restrictions like ShareAlike (SA), NoDerivatives (ND), and NonCommercial (NC) can be reinterpreted as such modular add-ons. They serve not as core licenses but as layered constraints that clarify the limitations on use, transformation, and distribution. Their status as modular clauses allows for more granular control and greater clarity, especially when attached to permissive base licenses that do not inherently define such boundaries.

A new proposed module, referred to as NL (No Learning), introduces a contemporary restriction relevant to the digital and algorithmic age. This clause prohibits the use of a licensed work, in whole or in part, for the training, fine-tuning, or calibration of machine learning models, neural networks, or any form of artificial intelligence systems. The rationale behind this module is rooted in concerns about data exploitation, algorithmic ownership, and the preservation of human authorship in the age of automated reproduction. As generative models rely heavily on vast corpora of human-created content, the NL module serves to assert an author's right to exclude their work from being absorbed into systems that may replicate, reinterpret, or monetize it without acknowledgment or compensation.

This new modular structure invites a more flexible and transparent legal landscape, where authors and rights holders may tailor licensing conditions according to evolving technological contexts. It also allows for the combination of multiple modules in a single license expression, thus granting a precise legal personality to each published work.

Example modular clauses in legal drafting style:

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This modular approach offers the legal and creative communities a more expressive framework, where rights and restrictions can be combined with precision and enforced with greater certainty across platforms and jurisdictions.

Conclusion

The introduction of the Creative Commons No-Person (CC-NP) license represents an important branching within the Creative Commons ecosystem, offering an alternative pathway between public domain dedication and attribution-based models. While not officially affiliated with Creative Commons, this license extends the philosophical foundations of the organization by addressing real-world needs that existing tools do not fully cover. Where traditional CC licenses focus on preserving attribution or imposing share-alike conditions, CC-NP carves out a distinct space for works that require both maximum freedom of use and protection against authorship misappropriation.

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